

A Park on Fire — *and Recovery*

2024–25 BUSHFIRE · SPATIAL OVERVIEW

100

DAYS OF
EMERGENCY

THE PARK AREA ~167,000 ha	DISTANCE TO MELBOURNE ~260 km northwest	HERITAGE Nationally listed (bio-cultural)	KEY TOWNS AT RISK Halls Gap · Stawell · Dunkeld · Horsham
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COUNTRY

TRADITIONAL OWNERS

Djab wurrung · Jadawadajali · Gunditjmara

Gariwerd has been occupied, cultivated, and shaped by its Traditional Owners for thousands of generations. During the 2025 fire, they used cultural burning to protect sacred sites while the rest of the park burned around them.

THE FIRE — 2024–25

135,800 ha

Total area burned — park and private land

~80 %

Of the national park affected by fire

422 km

Fire perimeter at peak of first fire

76,000 ha

Yarram Gap Road fire (first ignition)

59,000 ha

Wallaby Rocks fire (second ignition)

5,400 ha

Size after just 24 hours — up from 500 ha



KEY DATES & AGRICULTURAL IMPACT

KEY DATES		AGRICULTURAL IMPACT	
17 Dec 2024	● Dry lightning ignites the southern park	Farmland	● 13,538 ha burned, incl. 10,053 ha pasture
18 Dec 2024	● 500 ha to 5,400 ha in 24 hours	Fencing	● 540 km of fencing destroyed
7 Jan 2025	● First fire contained at 76,000 ha	Livestock	● 775 sheep, 1 horse, 1 beef cattle lost
27 Jan 2025	● Wallaby Rocks fire ignites in the west	Beehives	● 1,285 beehives destroyed
21 Feb 2025	● All fires out — 100 days of emergency management	Recovery	● \$1.88M in initial Parks Victoria works

ECOLOGY AT RISK

Brush-tailed Rock-wallaby

Native Blackfish

Grass trees (Xanthorrhoea)

Endemic plant species

Rock art sites

Heritage wetlands

Grampians Peaks Trail

Recovery began while fires were still burning — aerial predator control, food cache airlifts, Blackfish relocation, habitat monitoring. Grass trees began resprouting within weeks.